

the work of the mathematician Leonardo Fibonacci, who drew links between numerical sequences and geometrical shapes (see box).

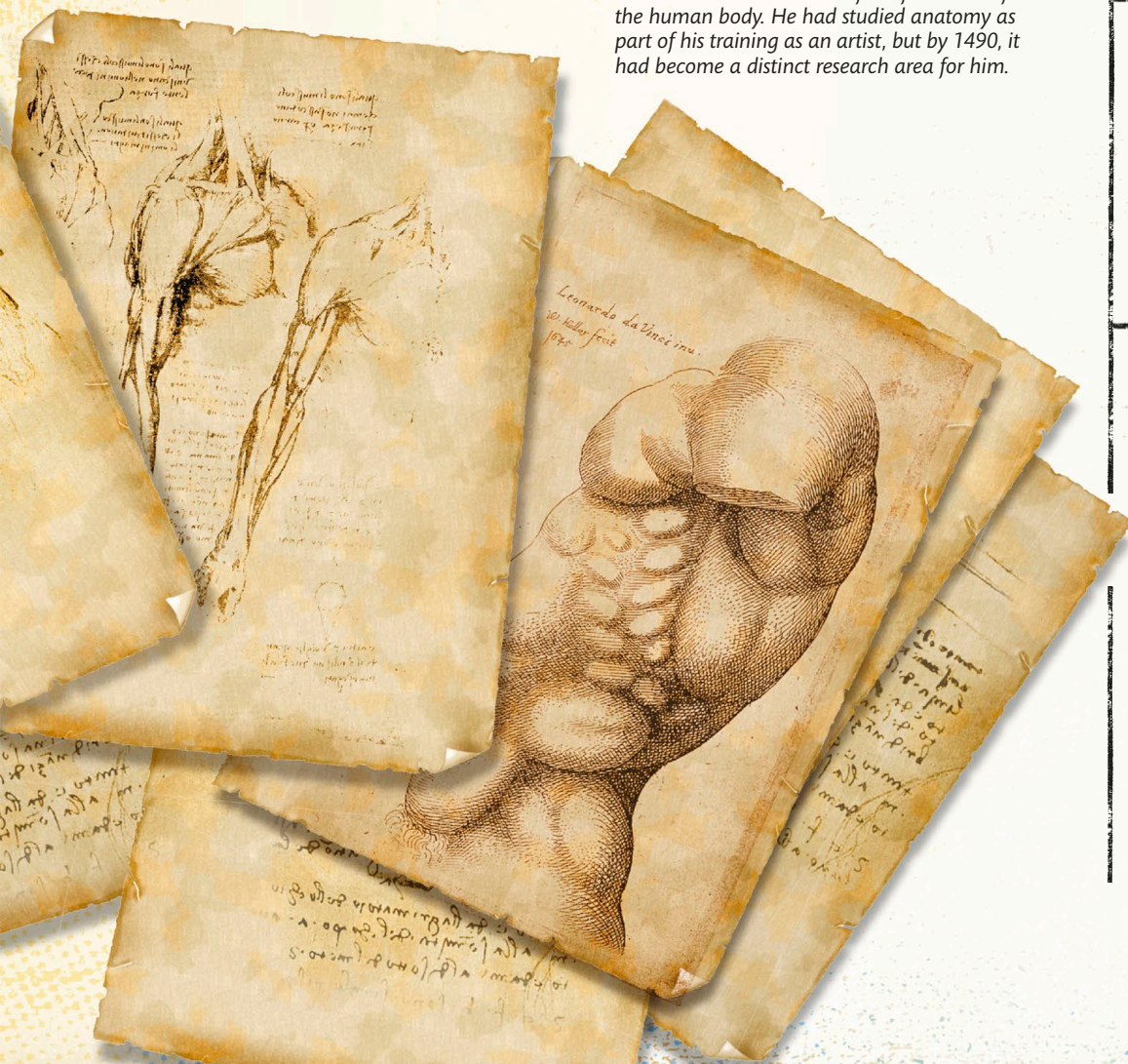
Enhanced accuracy

From 1502, da Vinci worked for the statesman Cesare Borgia in Rome. He completed a series of cartographic surveys, in which he used an aerial perspective rather than the traditional oblique view. He paced out the roads and squares to measure distances and used the newly invented theolodite—

an optical device used by surveyors—to measure angles, achieving an accuracy that had never been seen before.

Renowned as a brilliant thinker and artist beyond comparison, da Vinci was invited to France by King François I in 1516. He lived out his final years free from any obligation to paint, and instead prepared his many papers—on everything from anatomy to hydraulic engineering—for publication. However, due to the vast scale of his creativity, it proved too immense a task for da Vinci himself to complete.

Da Vinci's notebooks are full of sketches of the human body. He had studied anatomy as part of his training as an artist, but by 1490, it had become a distinct research area for him.



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